

STUMPRIDER · BUILD PLAN

StumpRider prototype build plan

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DOCUMENT CONTROL

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Author	Amish Chadha	License	CERN-OHL-S-2.0
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Source	docs/05-build-plan.md @ uncommitted		

REVISION HISTORY

Version	Date	Author	Change
0.2	2026-10-03	Amish Chadha	Round 2 decisions (SMR-DDR-003); hook head, interim rule lettered on the pole head, crutch kept on the canoe, local production variant costed for TRL 4
0.1	2026-10-03	Amish Chadha	First build plan; design made constructable (SMR-DDR-002)

Safety: StumpRider exists so that nobody enters the water. Nothing in this plan, including the first checks, puts a person in the water. The shear pin is the safety device: fit only pins from a reel that has passed the calibration in section 5, never a nail, bolt or steel wire. On the water, every person wears a life jacket, the operator kneels, and the crew cuts the net rather than risk a capsize. Until a heel test says otherwise, the tool is not used from a canoe under 7 m long or with fewer than three crew. Welding and galvanised steel give off fumes: weld in the open and never weld galvanised parts.

gunwale. There are 18 components: eleven are made (the ring, pole head, shear pins, pole sections, sleeves, float winder, jiggling weight, crutch frame, roller, clamp screw and the hook head for wrapped nets) and seven are bought (bolts, pins, rivets, cap, cord and a small tube). The steel parts are bent, cut, drilled and welded with a stick welder and then hot-dip galvanised; the aluminium parts are cut and drilled. The parts for one kit cost about USD 96 at prototype prices. The crutch stays clamped on the canoe as a fitting and the jiggling weight is kept at the landing, so the kit carried in the canoe is about 4.2 kg.

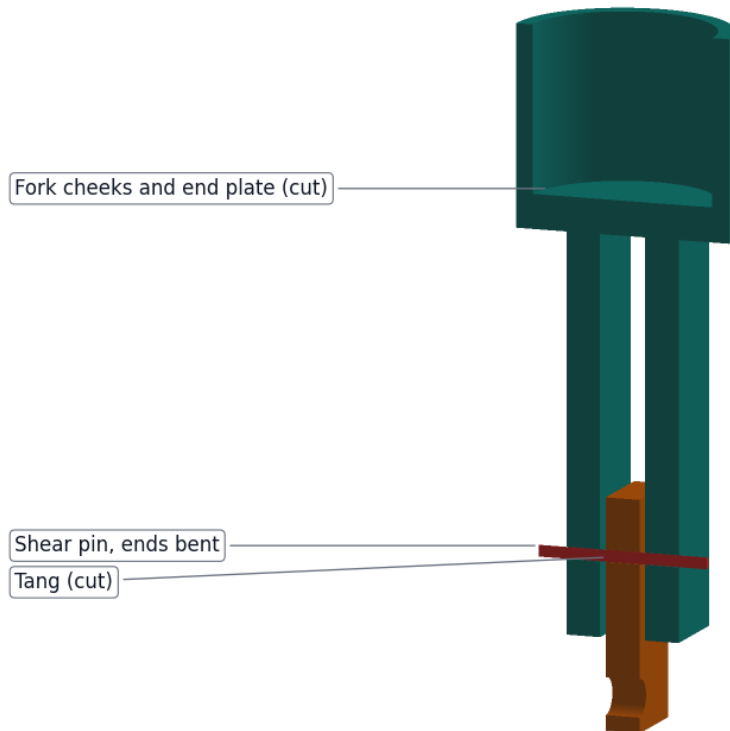
■ 2. What changed to make it buildable

Table 1. Changes from the concept (all recorded in SMR-DDR-002).

Component	The concept had	The buildable design has	Why
Rider ring	A split ring closed by a captive pin	Two half rings with ears at both joints: a bolt hinge on one side, a pinned gate on the other	A ring with a pin across a gap cannot open wide enough to take a line
Pole head and ring	A pole head with a shear pin	A steel socket and fork on the pole; a tang welded on the ring; the pin passes through fork and tang; the tang stops 45 mm short of the socket	Push and pull both go through the pin; twisting bears on the fork
Pole	Two or three sections	Three 1.45 m sections; riveted sleeves with lock pins	Packs to 1.55 m; joints cannot pull apart
Jiggling weight	A weight used on the tether cord	A weight that pins to the ring's tang in place of the pole	A weight loose on the cord would not move the ring
Gunwale crutch	A roller or crutch	A clamp-on steel saddle with a plastic roller	Fits gunwales 30 to 60 mm thick without drilling the canoe
Tether and float	Cord and float	A bowline through the tang; a notched foam winder	A defined tie; the float holds the ring and cord

Joint 4: fork on the tang, cut through the shear pin

1 mm each side of the tang; 45 mm from the tang top to the plate, so push and pull both go through the pin



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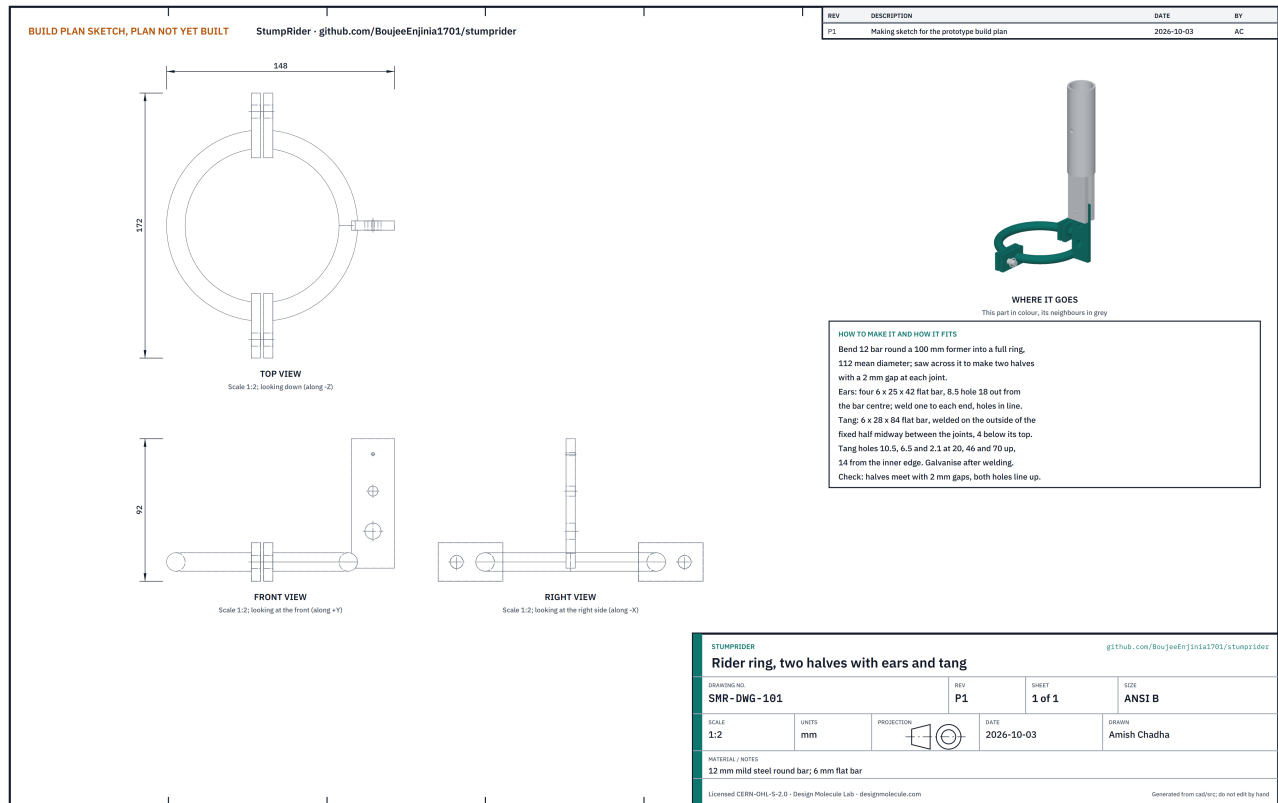
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Figure 2. The change that matters most: the shear pin is the only link between the pole and the ring.

■ 3. Making the components

Sizes are in millimetres. Weld only bare steel; galvanise after all welding and drilling of a part is done.

3.1 Rider ring (1)



What it is and what it is made from. Two half rings of 12 mm mild steel round bar, 100 inside and 124 outside, each with a flat ear at both ends; a flat tang stands up from the outside of the fixed half. About 0.40 m of bar and 0.25 m of 6 x 30 flat bar.

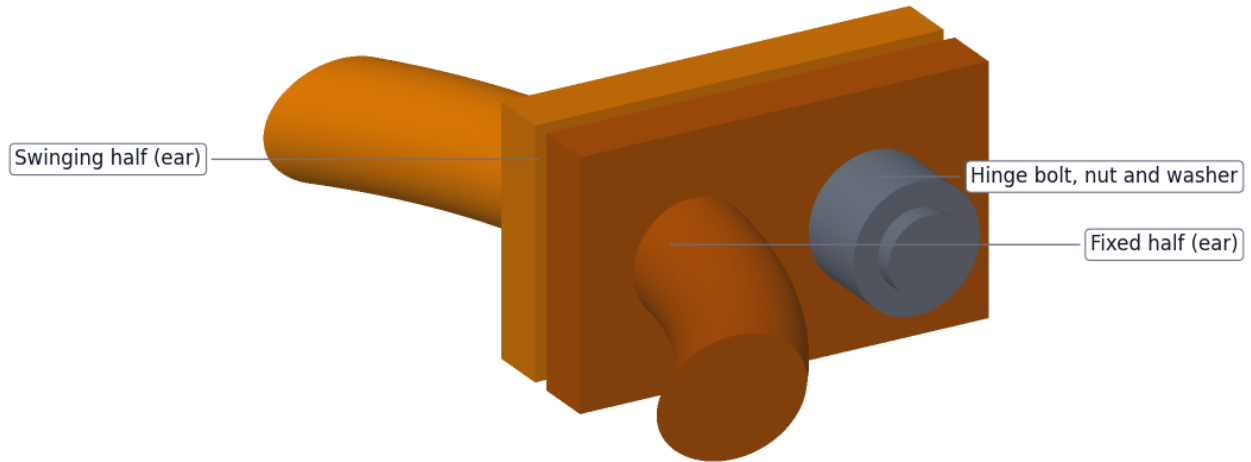
How to make it.

1. Bend 360 of 12 bar round a 100 mm round former (a pipe or a turned block) into a full ring, ends meeting.
2. Mark two points opposite each other and saw across the ring at both, taking out 2 at each cut so the halves meet with a 2 gap.
3. Cut four ears of 6 x 25 flat bar, 42 long. Drill an 8.5 hole in each, 18 out from where the bar centre will sit.
4. Clamp the halves on a flat plate with 2 spacers in the gaps. Weld one ear on the end of each half, faces flat to the joint, so each pair of ears faces the other with a 2 gap and the holes line up.
5. Cut the tang from 6 x 28 flat bar, 84 long. Drill 10.5, 6.5 and 2.1 holes on its centre line at 20, 46 and 70 from the end that will sit lowest.
6. Weld the tang upright on the outside of one half, midway between its ears, with its lower end 4 below the top of the bar and its flat faces square to the ring. This is the fixed half.
7. Grind the welds smooth inside the ring so it slides on a line. Send for galvanising with the other steel parts.

How it fits the parts next to it. The ears meet face to face; the hinge bolt goes through one pair and the gate pin through the other.

Joint 1: the ring hinge

Two ears face to face, 2 mm apart; M8 bolt through both, nyloc nut snug so the half still swings



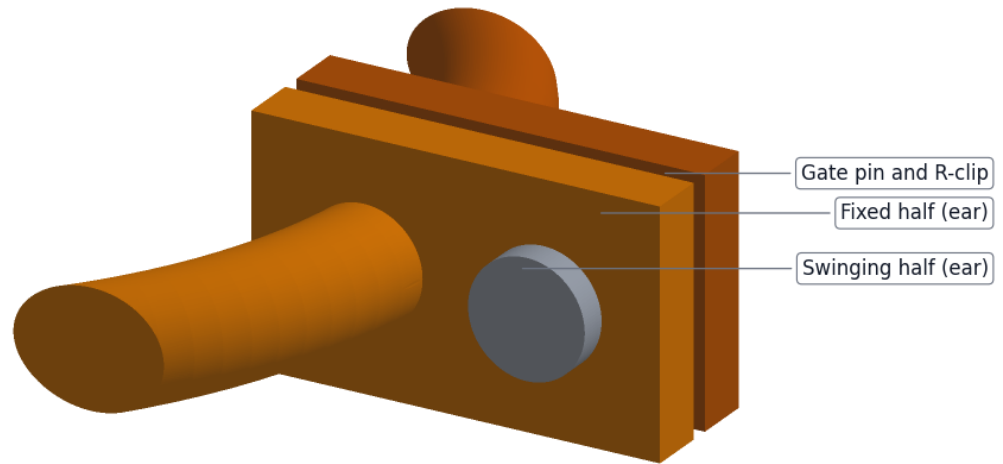
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Figure 3. The hinge: M8 bolt through both ears, nyloc nut snug.

Joint 2: the ring gate

Clevis pin from the swinging side, R-clip on the fixed side; the lanyard keeps both on the ring



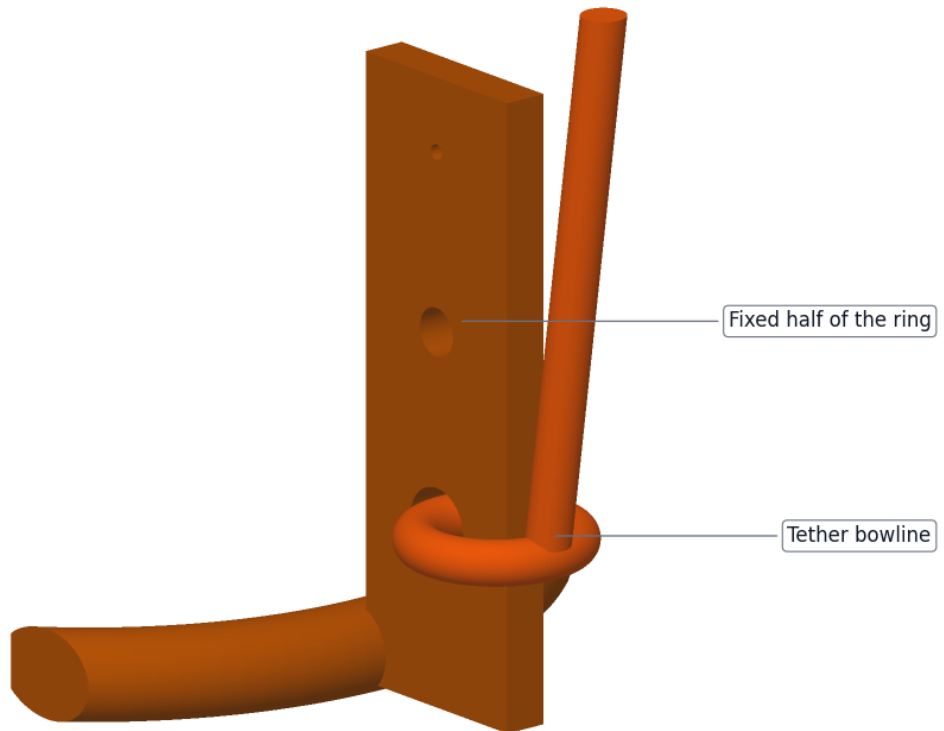
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Figure 4. The gate: clevis pin with R-clip and lanyard.

Joint 3: tang welded to the ring; tether tied through the lowest hole

Tang on the outside of the bar, welded both sides; bowline through the 10.5 mm hole, round the outer edge



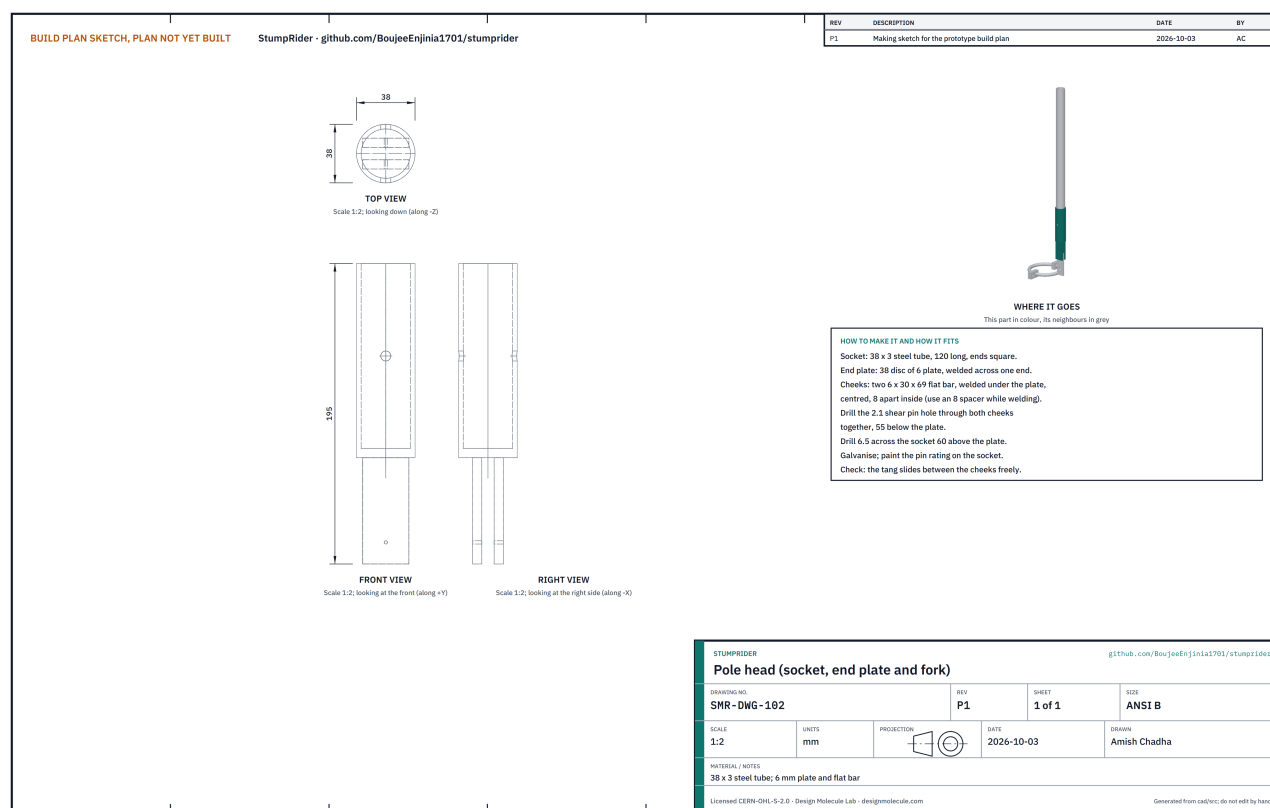
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Figure 5. The tang, welded on the outside of the bar.

Check before moving on. Both pairs of holes line up with an 8 rod through them; the gaps are 2; the tang stands square; an 8 drill passes the ring's inside without catching on a weld.

3.2 Pole head (4)



What it is and what it is made from. A steel socket that slips over the bottom of the pole, closed by an end plate, with two fork cheeks under it. 38 x 3 steel tube, 6 plate and 6 x 30 flat bar.

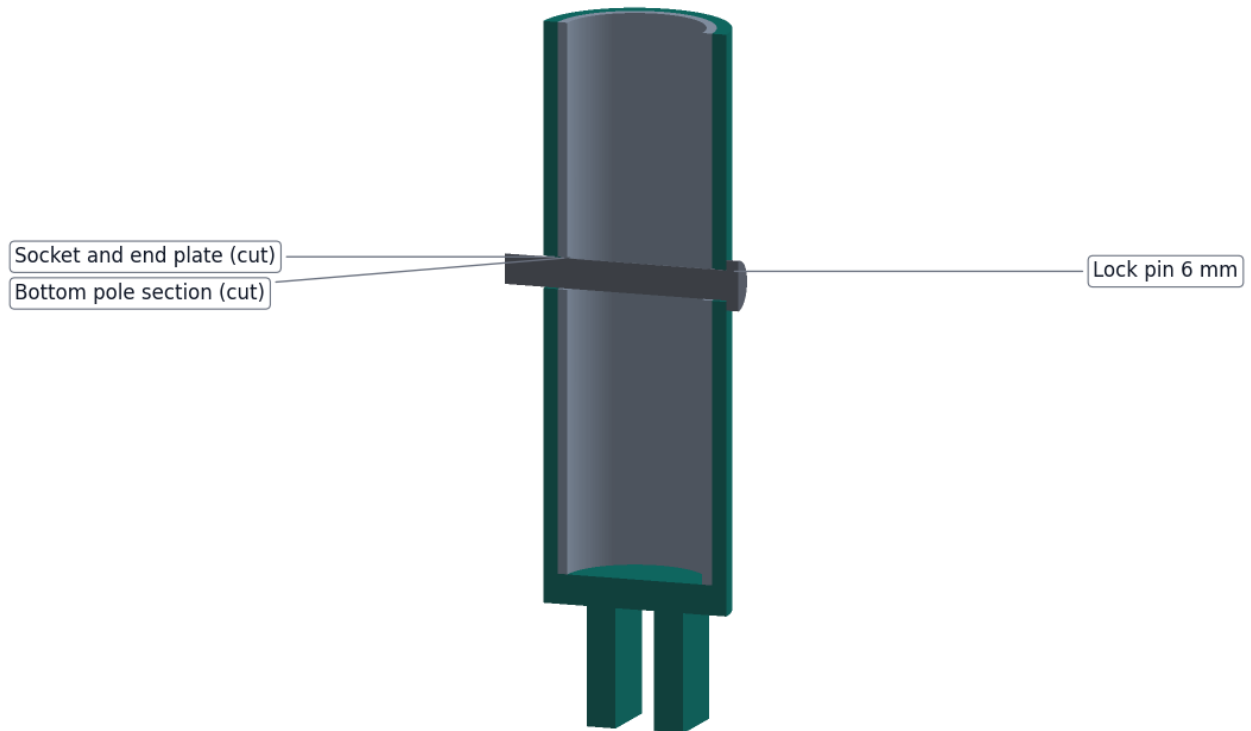
How to make it.

1. Cut 120 of 38 x 3 tube with square ends; cut a 38 disc from 6 plate.
2. Weld the disc across one end of the tube.
3. Cut two cheeks of 6 x 30 flat bar, 69 long.
4. Hold the cheeks under the disc with an 8 thick spacer between them, centred on the disc and square to it, and weld them to the disc.
5. Clamp the cheeks together on the spacer and drill a 2.1 hole through both, 55 below the disc, on their centre line.
6. Drill a 6.5 hole straight across the tube, 60 above the disc.
7. Galvanise. Paint "302 N PIN ONLY" on the tube, and under it the interim rule "ONLY CANOES 7 m OR LONGER WITH 3 CREW" (SMR-DDR-003). The rule stays until the heel tests by canoe class set a pin for smaller canoes.

How it fits the parts next to it. The pole goes into the tube until it rests on the disc and is held by a lock pin. The cheeks straddle the ring's tang with 1 clear each side; the tang's top stops 45 below the disc, so it never touches it.

Joint 5: pole in the head socket, cut

Pole pushed in to the end plate; lock pin through socket and pole, R-clip on the far side



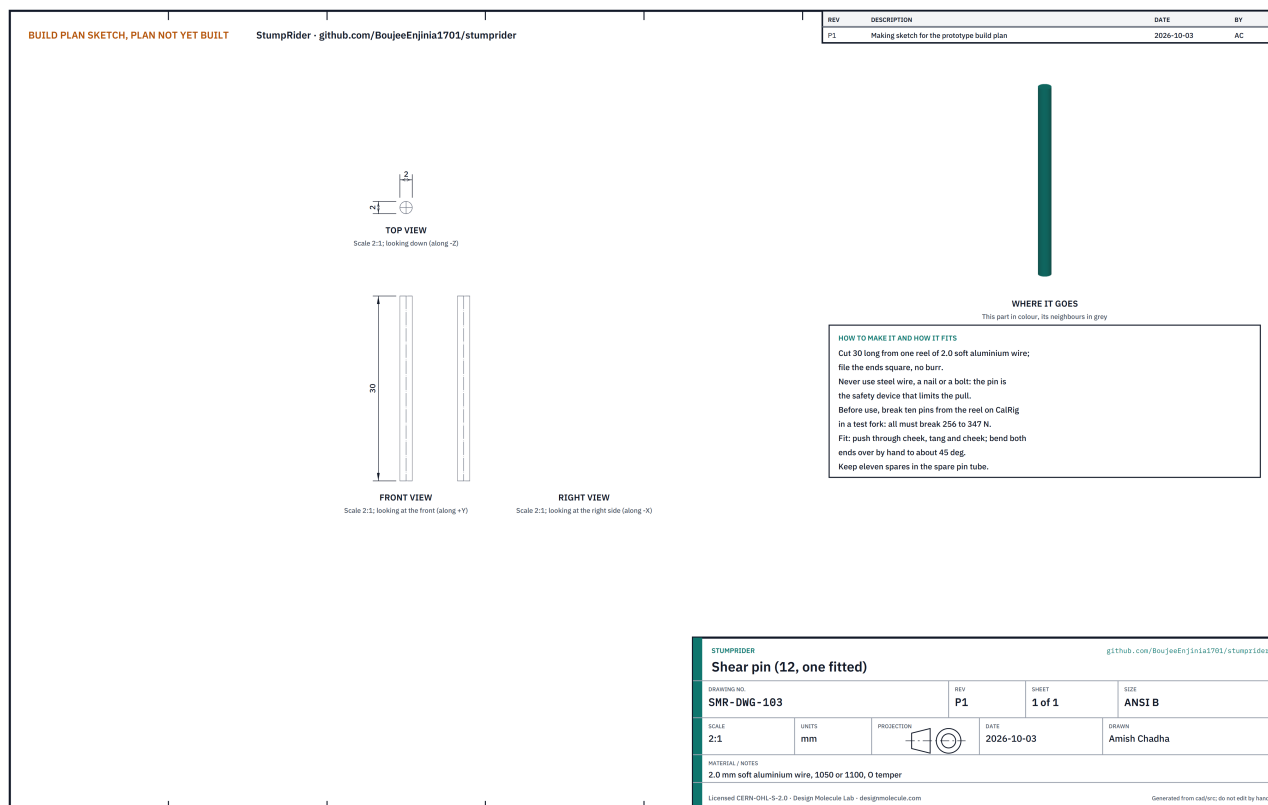
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Figure 6. Pole in the socket, lock pin through both.

Check before moving on. The pole slides in by hand and seats on the disc; the tang slides between the cheeks without binding; a 2 rod passes cheek, tang and cheek holes when lined up.

3.3 Shear pins (5)



What it is and what it is made from. Short lengths of 2.0 soft aluminium wire (1050 or 1100 alloy, soft temper). They are the safety link: each breaks at about 300 N (30 kg pull).

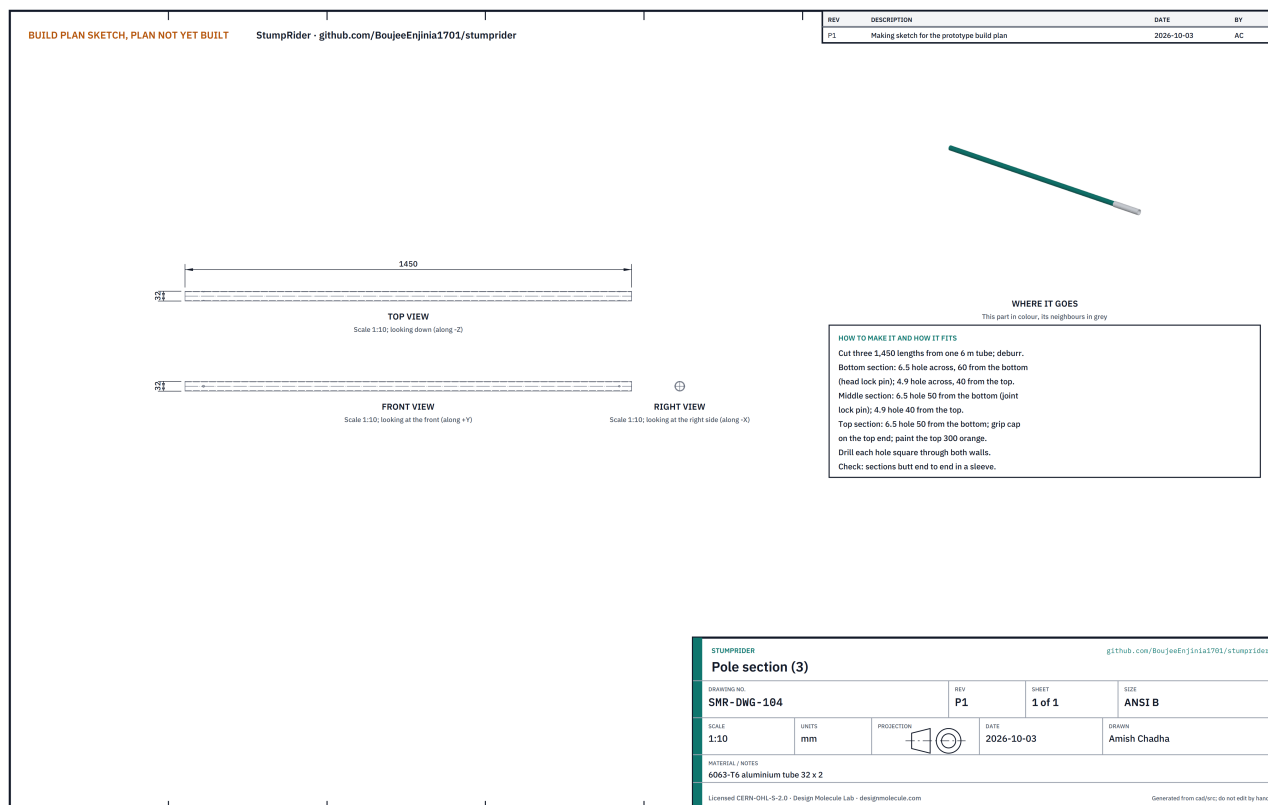
How to make it.

1. Take all pins from one reel of wire and label the reel.
2. Cut twelve pins 30 long; file the ends square, no burr.
3. Calibrate the reel before any pin is used (section 5, check 1).
4. Put eleven in the spare pin tube.

How it fits the parts next to it. Pushed through cheek, tang and cheek; both ends bent over by hand to about 45 degrees so it cannot fall out. It is never replaced by a nail, a bolt or steel wire.

Check before moving on. The reel has passed calibration; every pin is straight and the same length.

3.4 Pole sections (6)



What it is and what it is made from. Three 1,450 lengths of 6063-T6 aluminium tube, 32 outside, 2 wall, cut from one 6 m length.

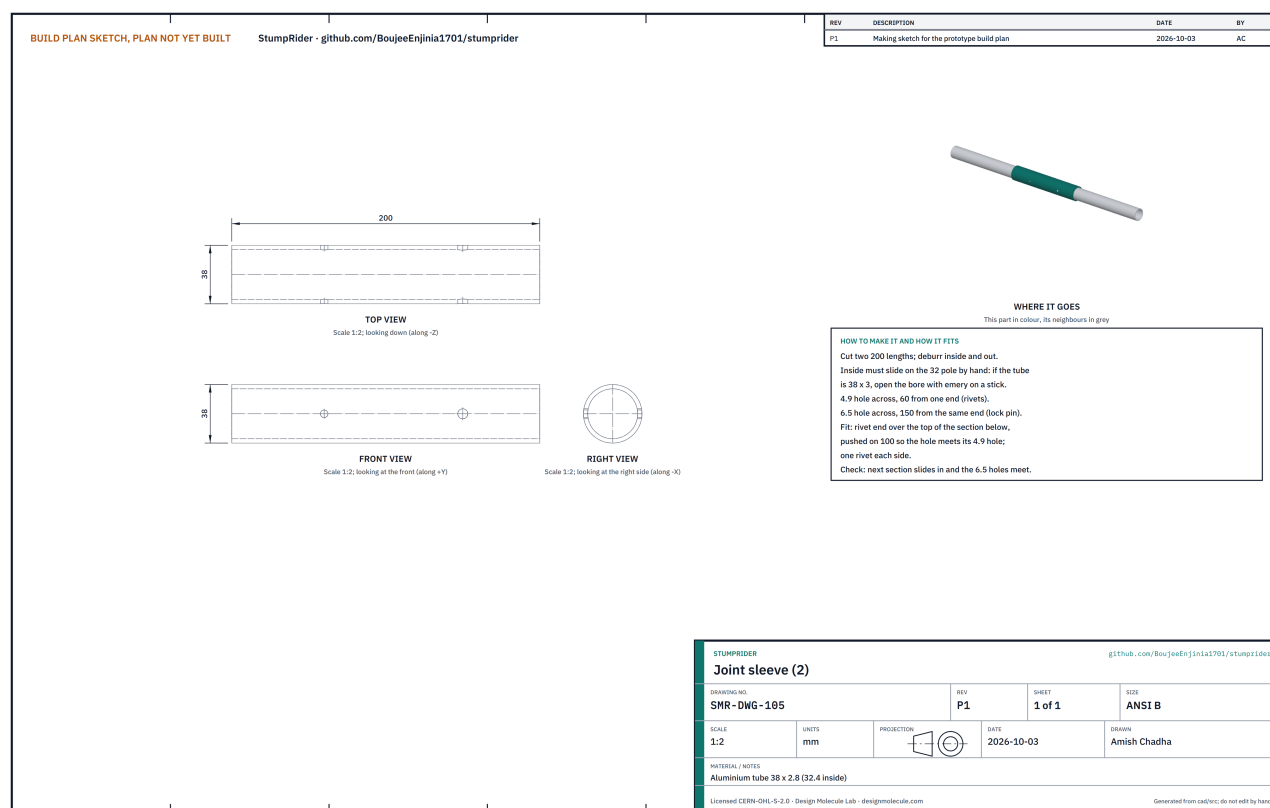
How to make it.

1. Cut three 1,450 lengths; deburr inside and out.
2. Bottom section: drill 6.5 straight across, 60 from the bottom end (head lock pin), and 4.9 across, 40 from the top end (rivets).
3. Middle section: 6.5 across, 50 from the bottom end (joint lock pin), and 4.9 across, 40 from the top end.
4. Top section: 6.5 across, 50 from the bottom end. Paint the top 300 orange.
5. Drill every hole square through both walls, with the tube in a vee block.

How it fits the parts next to it. The sections butt end to end inside the sleeves (3.5); the grip cap goes on the top of the top section.

Check before moving on. All three are the same length within 2; every hole goes straight through.

3.5 Joint sleeves (7)



What it is and what it is made from. Two 200 lengths of aluminium tube, 38 outside and 32.4 inside, so the pole slides in by hand.

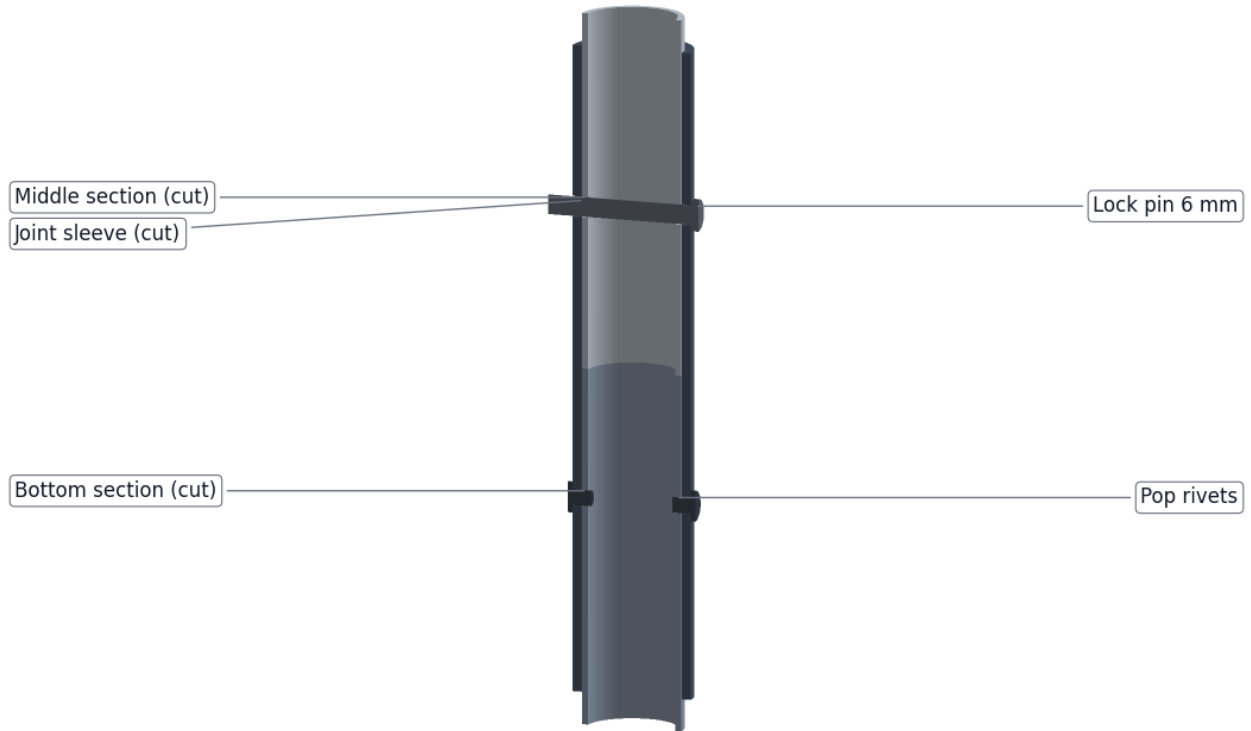
How to make it.

1. Cut two 200 lengths; deburr.
2. If the tube is 38 x 3 (32 inside), open the bore with emery cloth on a stick until a pole section slides in by hand.
3. Drill 4.9 across, 60 from one end (rivets), and 6.5 across, 150 from the same end (lock pin).

How it fits the parts next to it. The rivet end goes 100 over the top of the bottom (or middle) section and is fixed with two rivets, one each side. The next section slides into the free end until it butts and is held by a lock pin.

Joint 6: pole joint, cut

Sleeve riveted to the section below; the section above butts on it and is held by the lock pin



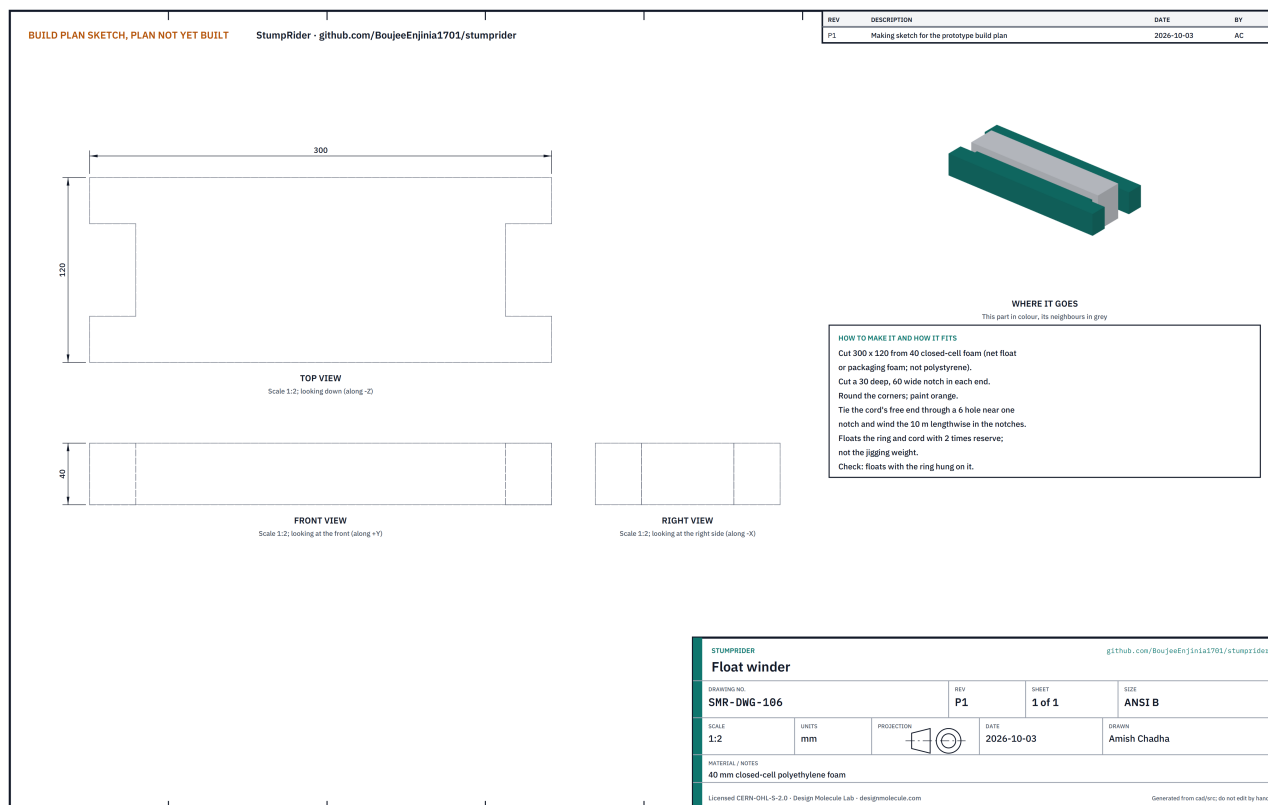
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Figure 7. Pole joint: sleeve riveted below, pinned above.

Check before moving on. The next section slides in and its 6.5 hole lines up with the sleeve's.

3.6 Float winder (12)



What it is and what it is made from. A flat winder for the tether cord, 300 x 120 cut from 40 closed-cell polyethylene foam (net-float or packaging foam, never polystyrene).

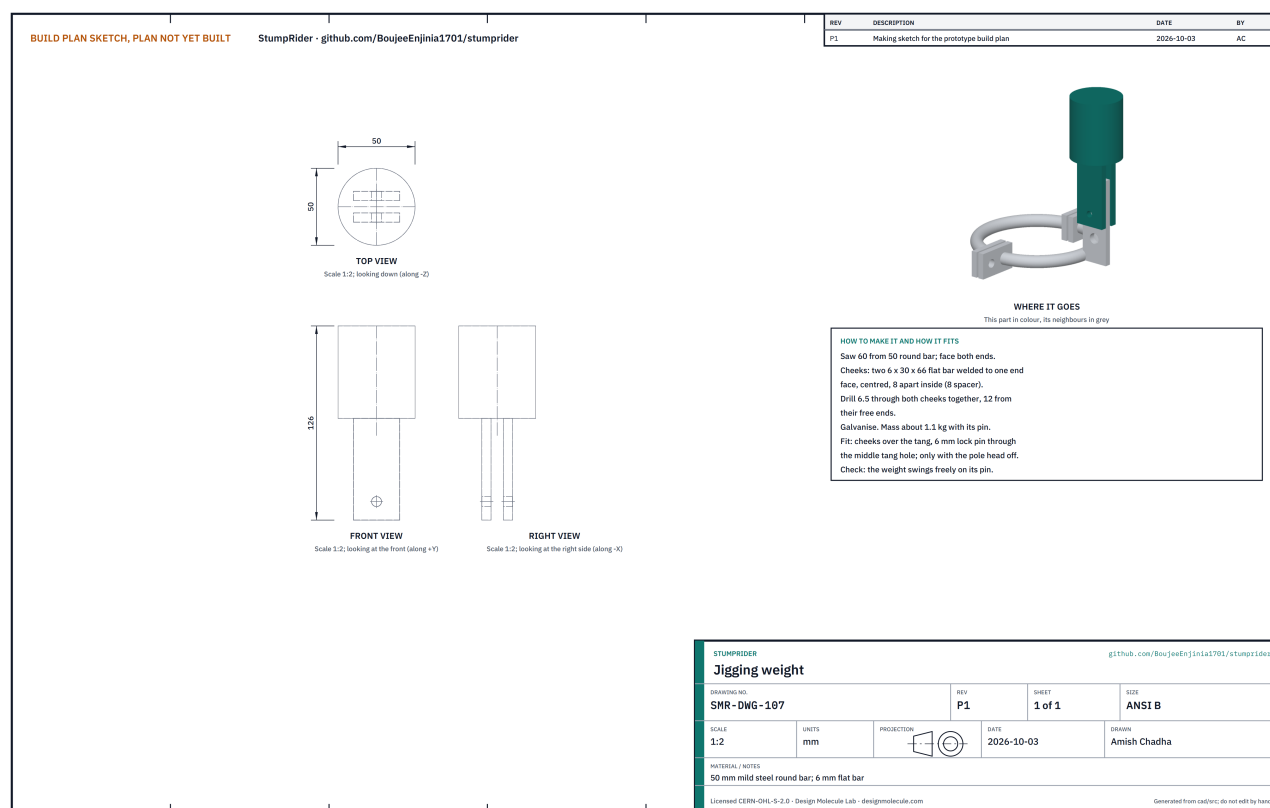
How to make it.

1. Cut the 300 x 120 blank with a sharp knife.
2. Cut a notch 30 deep and 60 wide in each end.
3. Round the corners; paint orange.
4. Push a 6 hole through near one notch for the cord's end.

How it fits the parts next to it. The cord is wound lengthwise through the notches; the spare pin tube is tied to it.

Check before moving on. With the ring hung on it in a bucket of water, it floats.

3.7 Jigging weight (14)



What it is and what it is made from. A 1.1 kg steel weight with a fork that pins to the ring's tang. 50 round bar and 6 x 30 flat bar.

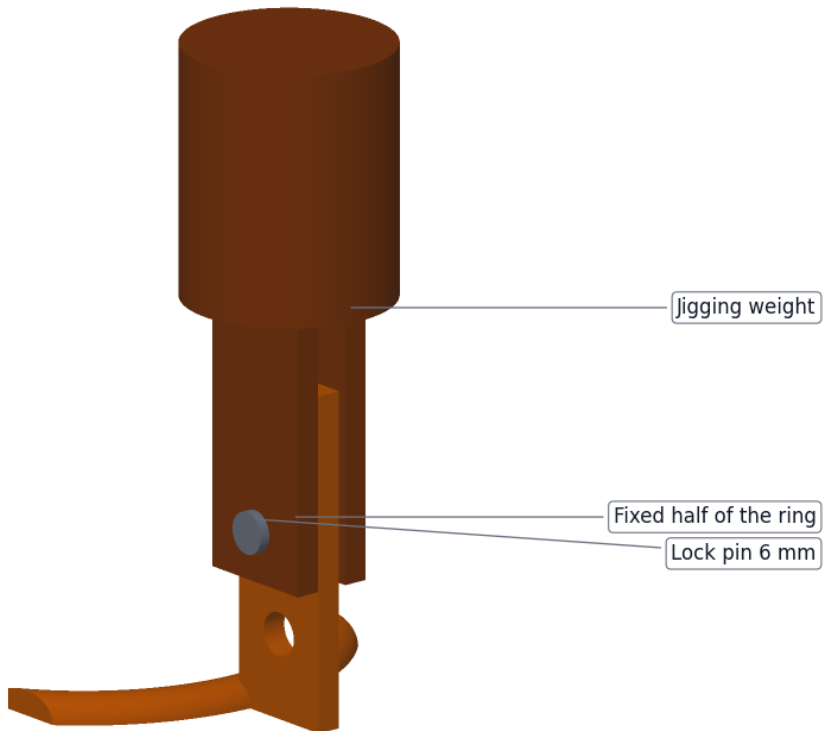
How to make it.

1. Saw 60 from 50 round bar; face both ends flat.
2. Cut two cheeks of 6 x 30 flat bar, 66 long.
3. Weld them to one end face, centred, with an 8 spacer between them.
4. Clamp on the spacer and drill 6.5 through both, 12 from their free ends.
5. Galvanise.

How it fits the parts next to it. With the pole head off, the cheeks go over the tang and a lock pin goes through the tang's middle hole.

Joint 7: jiggling weight on the tang

Pole head off; weight cheeks over the tang, lock pin through the middle hole



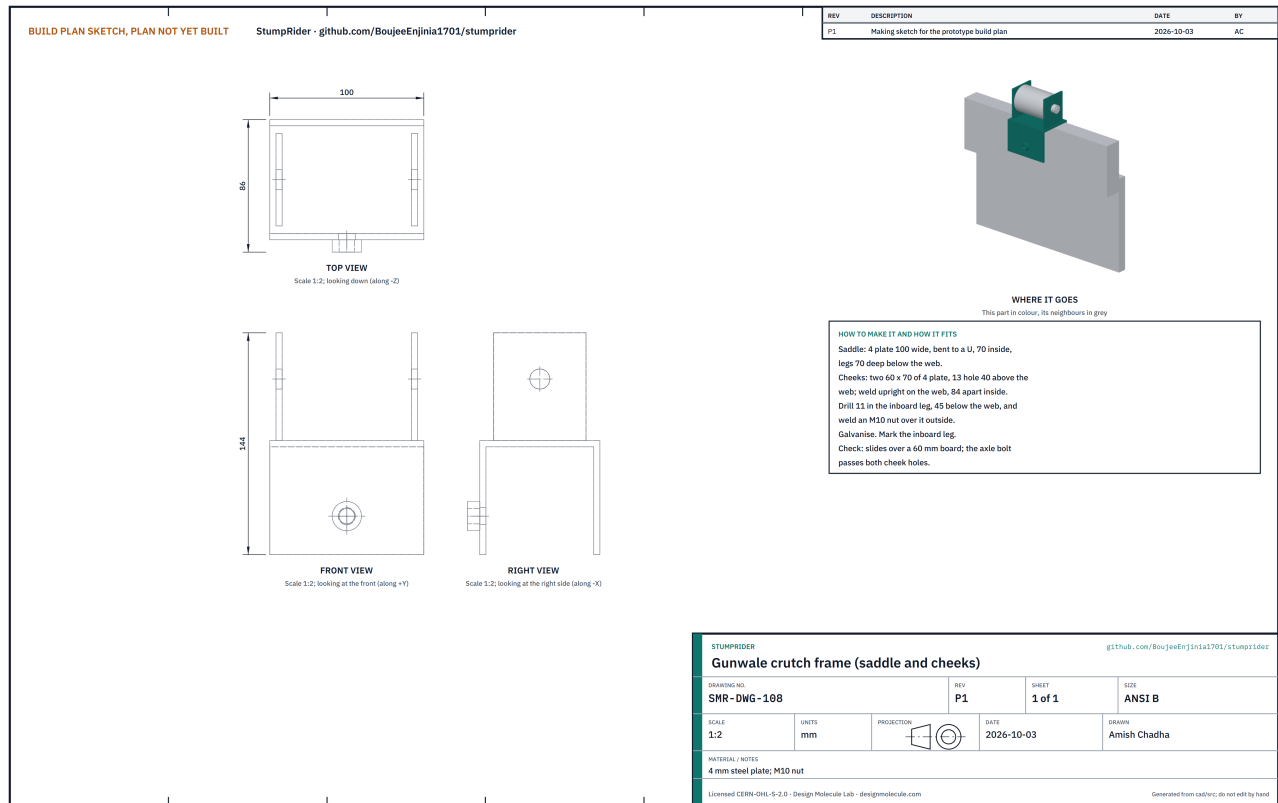
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Figure 8. The jiggling weight pinned to the tang.

Check before moving on. The weight swings freely on its pin and clears the tether knot.

3.8 Gunwale crutch frame (15)



What it is and what it is made from. A U saddle that sits over the gunwale, with two cheeks that carry the roller. 4 steel plate and an M10 nut.

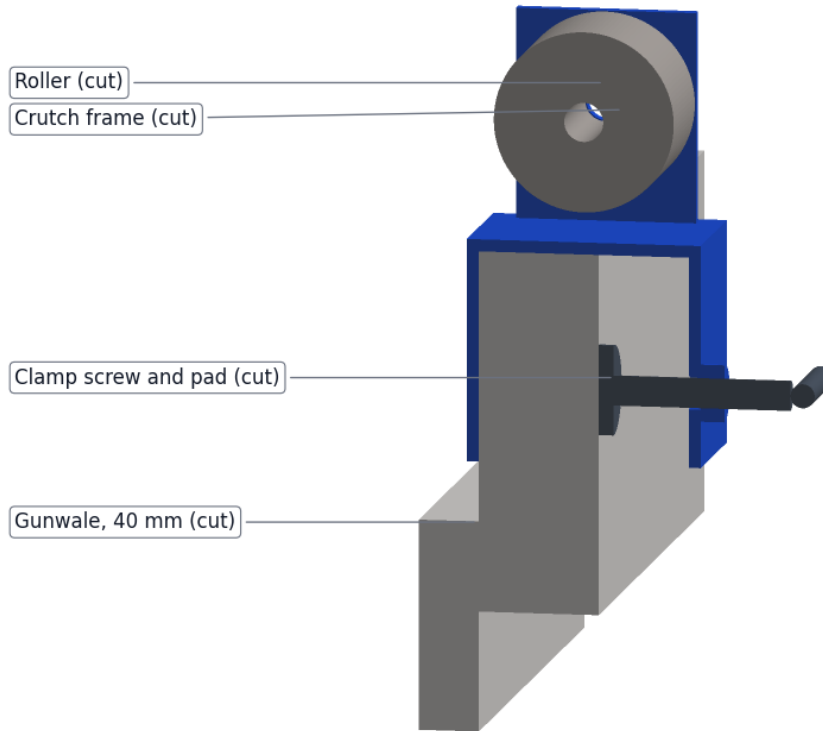
How to make it.

1. Cut a strip of 4 plate 100 wide and 218 long. Bend it to a U, 70 inside, with legs 70 deep below the web.
2. Cut two cheeks 60 x 70 from 4 plate; drill 13 in each, centred across, 40 above where it will sit on the web.
3. Weld the cheeks upright on the web, 84 apart inside, holes in line.
4. Drill 11 in one leg, 45 below the web, centred; weld an M10 nut over it on the outside. This is the inboard leg; mark it.
5. Galvanise.

How it fits the parts next to it. The web sits on the top of the gunwale, the outboard leg against the outside of the canoe; the clamp screw's pad bears on the inside face.

Joint 8: crutch on the gunwale, cut across

Web on the gunwale top, outboard leg against the outside; the pad clamps the inboard face



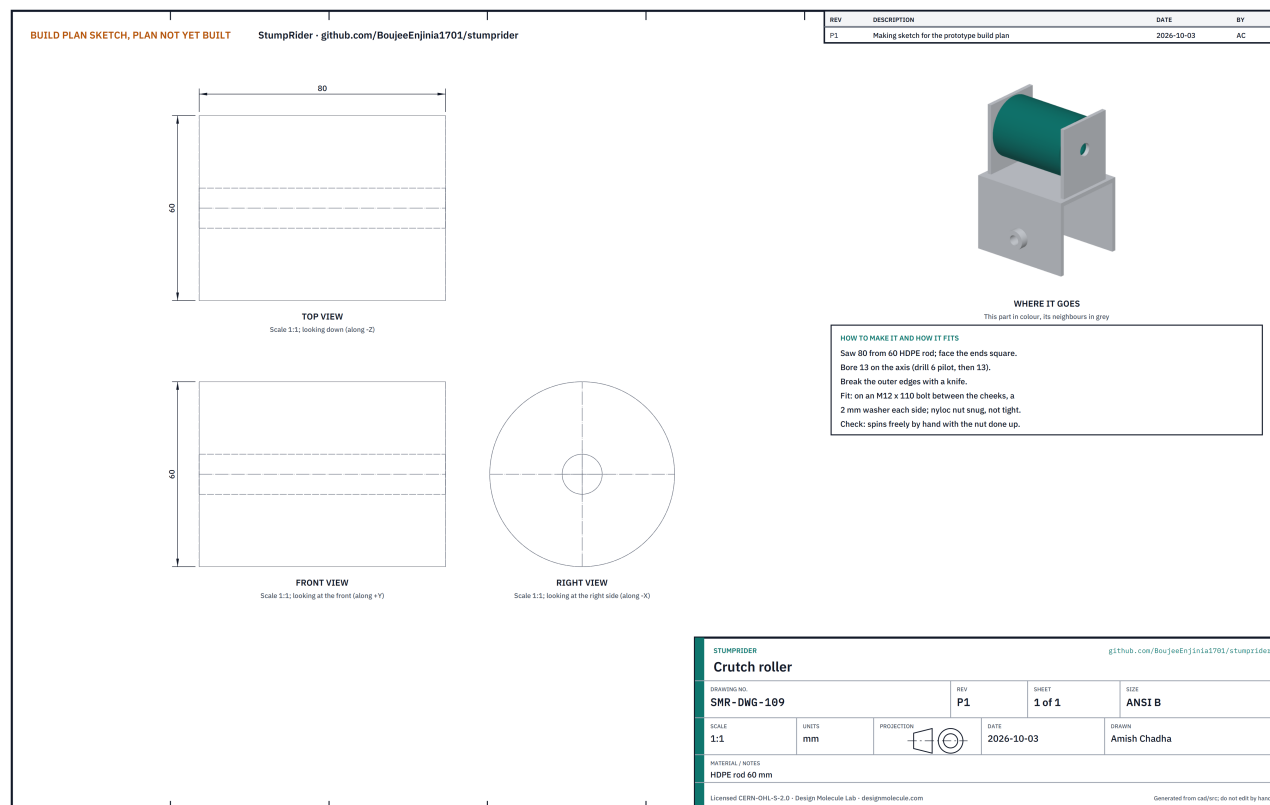
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Figure 9. The crutch on a 40 mm gunwale.

Check before moving on. It slides over a 60 board; an M12 bolt passes both cheek holes.

3.9 Crutch roller (16)



What it is and what it is made from. An 80 length of 60 HDPE rod, bored to run on an M12 bolt.

How to make it.

1. Saw 80 from the rod; face the ends square.
2. Drill a 6 pilot on the axis, then open it to 13.
3. Take the sharp outer edges off with a knife.

How it fits the parts next to it. On an M12 x 110 bolt between the cheeks, with a 2 washer each side; the nyloc nut is snug, not tight.

Joint 9: roller on its axle, cut

2 mm washer each side; nyloc nut snug so the roller spins and the cheeks are not pulled in



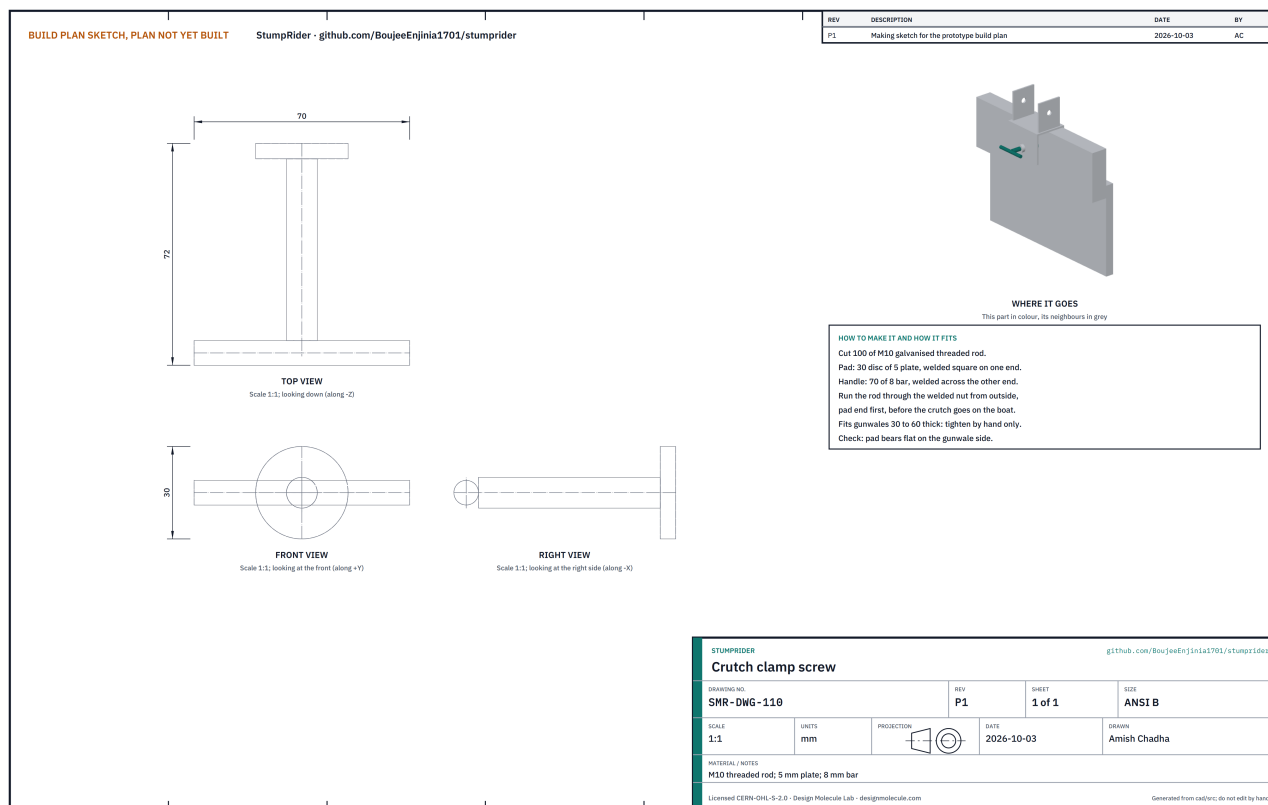
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Figure 10. Roller, washers and axle bolt.

Check before moving on. It spins freely by hand with the nut done up.

3.10 Crutch clamp screw (17)



What it is and what it is made from. 100 of M10 galvanised threaded rod with a 30 pad on one end and a 70 handle across the other.

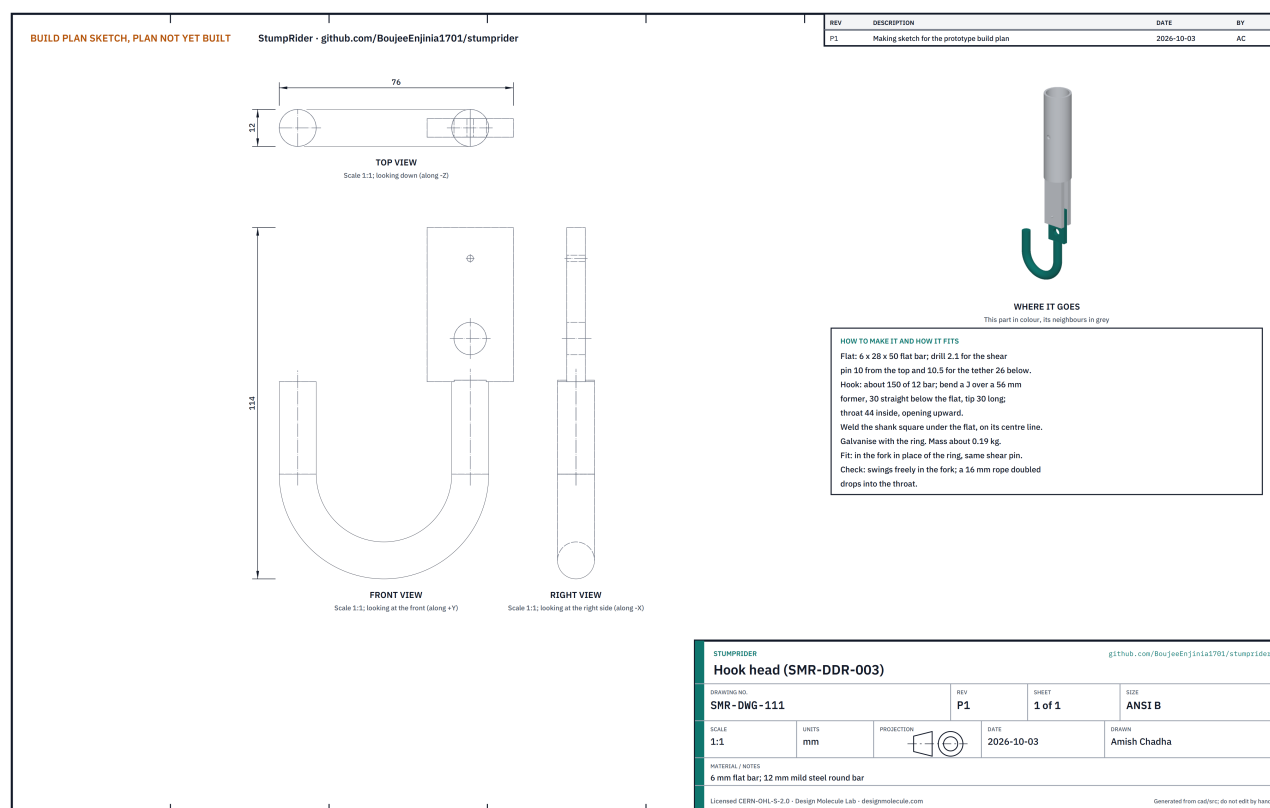
How to make it.

1. Cut 100 of M10 rod.
2. Weld a 30 disc of 5 plate square on one end (grind the zinc off the weld area first, outdoors).
3. Weld 70 of 8 round bar across the other end. Touch up the welds with zinc-rich paint.

How it fits the parts next to it. It runs through the nut on the crutch's inboard leg, pad end in first.

Check before moving on. It turns by hand through the full 30 to 60 range.

3.11 Hook head (21)



What it is and what it is made from. A second head for the end of the pole, used in place of the ring when a net is wrapped round a branch: a J hook that catches the bight of the net and draws it back round the branch (SMR-DDR-003). 6 x 28 flat bar and 12 round bar.

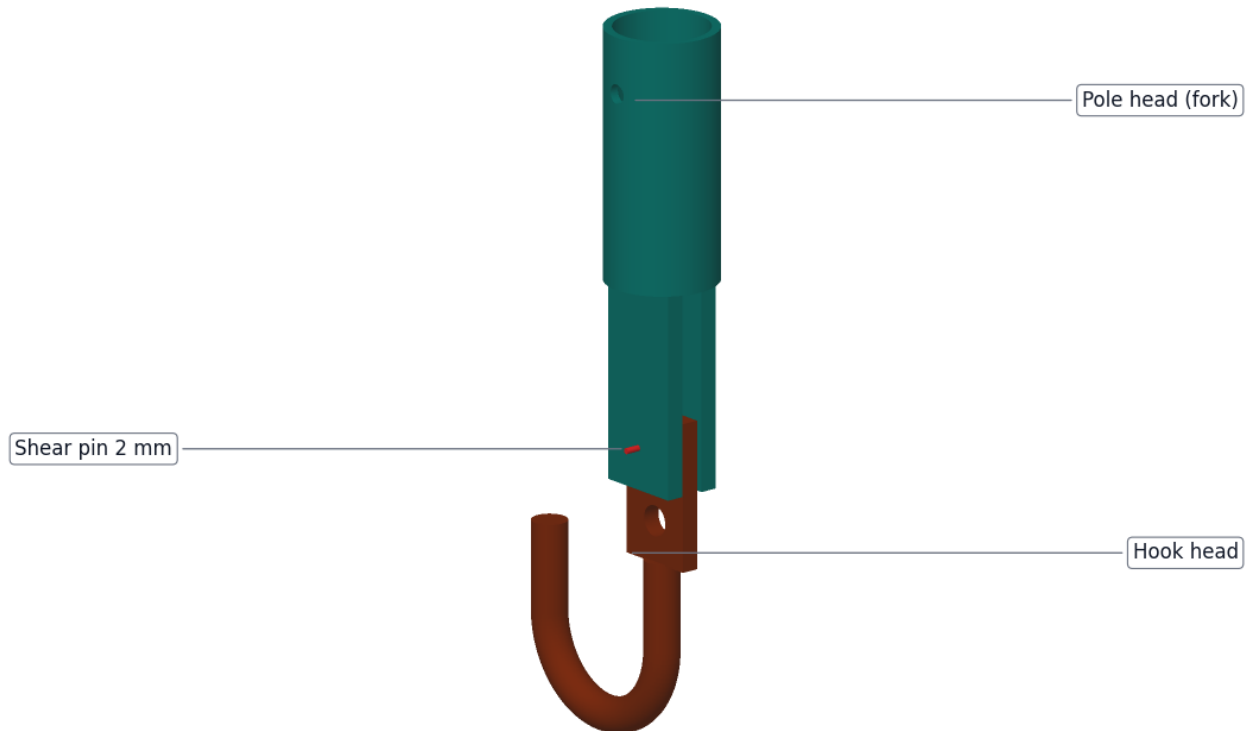
How to make it.

1. Cut 50 of 6 x 28 flat bar. Drill 2.1 for the shear pin 10 from the top and 10.5 for the tether 26 below it, on the centre line.
2. Cut about 150 of 12 bar. Bend a J over a 56 round former: 30 straight, the bend, and a 30 tip parallel to the straight; the throat is 44 inside.
3. Weld the straight end square under the flat, on its centre line, with the hook opening upward.
4. Galvanise with the ring.

How it fits the parts next to it. With the ring off the pole, the flat goes between the fork cheeks and takes the same calibrated shear pin, so it lets go at the same load as the ring.

Joint 10: hook head in the fork (SMR-DDR-003)

Ring off; the hook head's flat goes between the fork cheeks and takes the same shear pin



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Figure 11. Hook head in the fork, shear pin through.

Check before moving on. The hook head swings freely in the fork; a 2 rod passes cheek, flat and cheek holes when lined up; a 16 rope doubled drops into the throat. About 0.19 kg.

3.12 Bought components

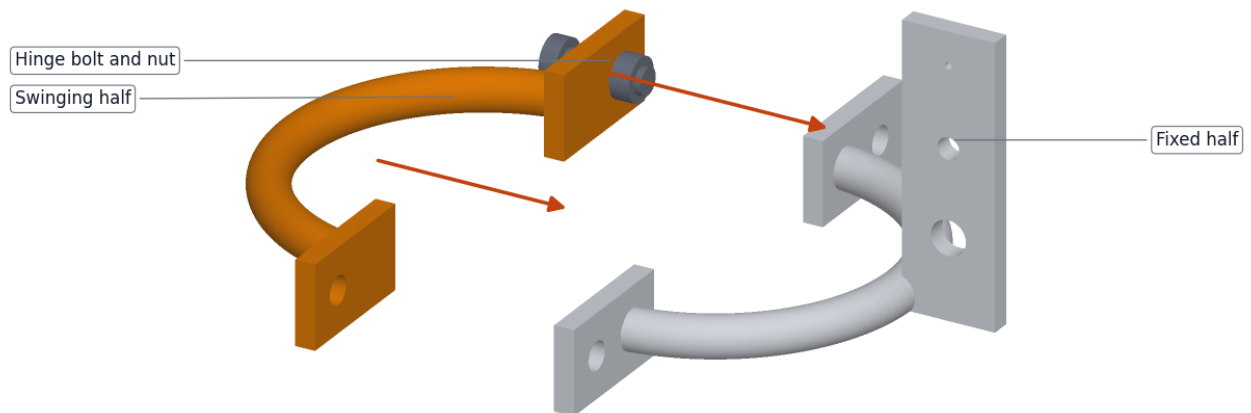
- **Hinge bolt (2):** M8 x 30 stainless bolt, nyloc nut and two washers.
- **Gate pin (3):** 8 x 30 stainless clevis pin with an R-clip; tie a 300 length of 3 cord through the R-clip and round the gate ear.
- **Pop rivets (8):** four 4.8 stainless blind rivets, grip 4 to 6.
- **Lock pins (9):** four 6 x 50 stainless clevis pins with R-clips; tie a short lanyard to each.
- **Grip cap (10):** rubber cap for 32 tube, 30 deep.
- **Tether cord (11):** 10 m of 6 braided polyester; heat-seal both ends.
- **Spare pin tube (13):** a small capped vial about 14 across and 80 long; tie it to the winder.

■ 4. Putting it together

Step 1: hinge the ring halves

Step 1: hinge the two ring halves

Ears face to face at the +Y joint; M8 bolt through both, nyloc nut snug



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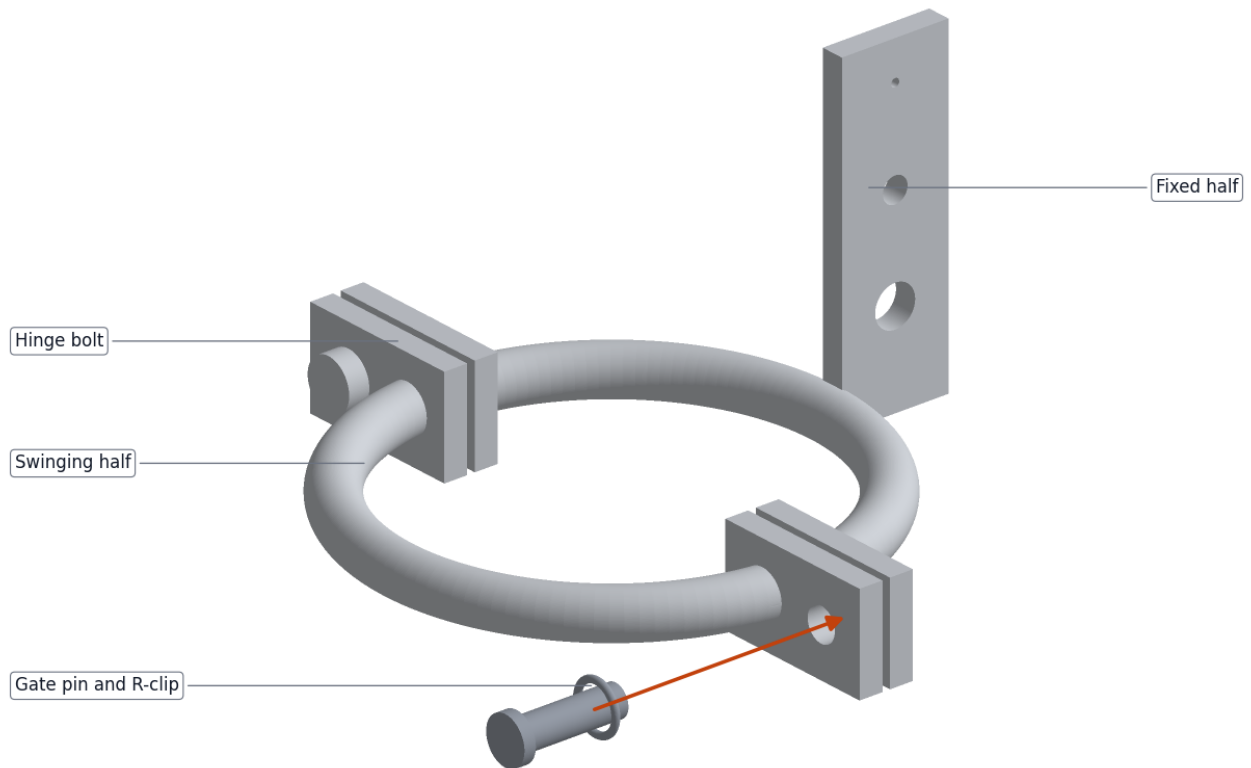
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Lay the halves together with the hinge ears face to face. Push the M8 bolt through, add the nyloc nut and tighten until the swinging half still moves under its own weight.

Step 2: close the gate

Step 2: close the gate with the gate pin

Pin in from the swinging side, R-clip on; tie the lanyard through the clip and the ear



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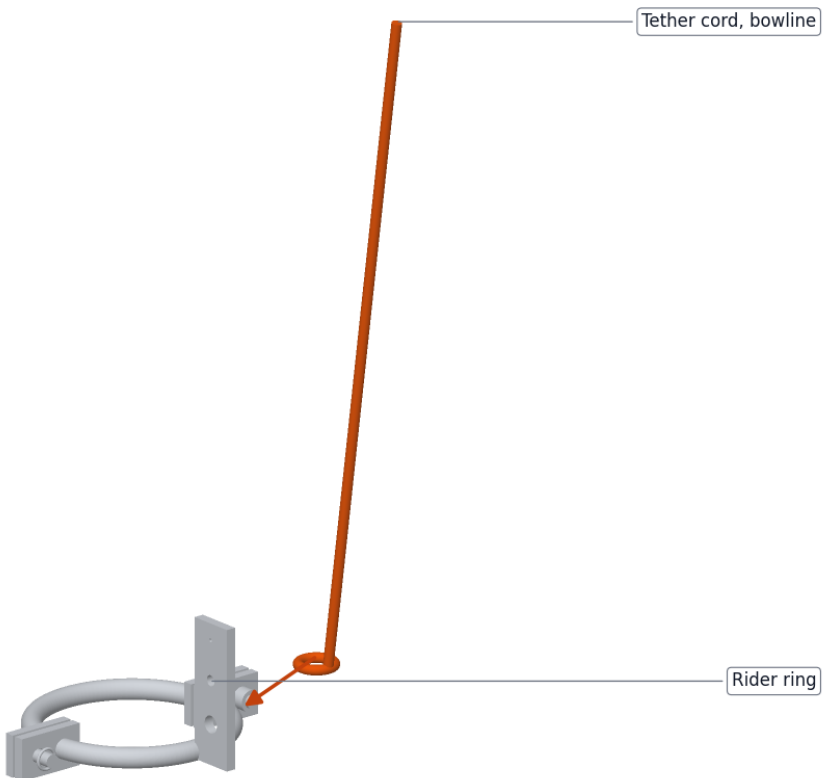
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Swing the halves shut, push the gate pin in from the swinging side and fit the R-clip. Tie the lanyard through the R-clip and round the ear.

Step 3: tie on the tether

Step 3: tie the tether to the tang

Bowline through the lowest tang hole; wind the rest on the float winder; tie its end to a thwart in use



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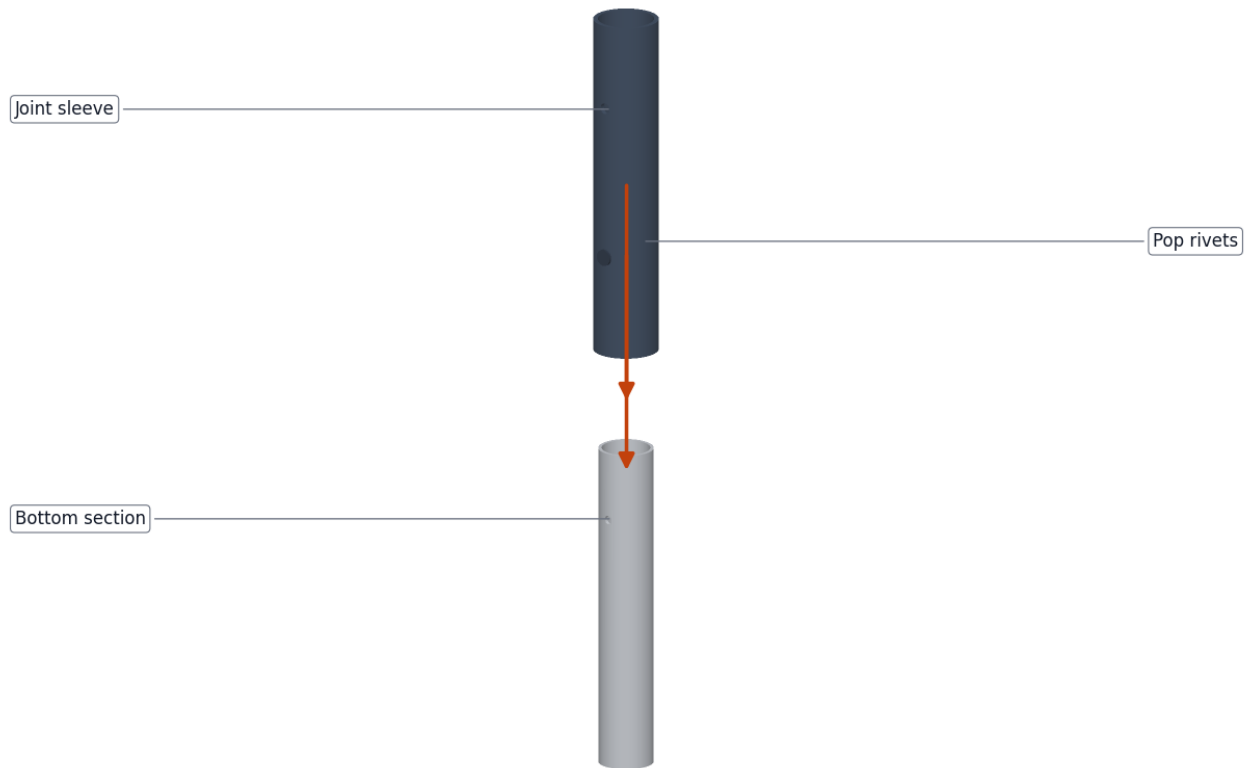
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Tie the cord's end through the tang's lowest hole with a bowline round the tang's outer edge. Wind the rest on the float winder and tie the far end through the winder's hole.

Step 4: rivet the sleeves

Step 4: rivet a sleeve on the top of the bottom and middle sections

Push the sleeve on 100 mm until the holes meet; one rivet each side



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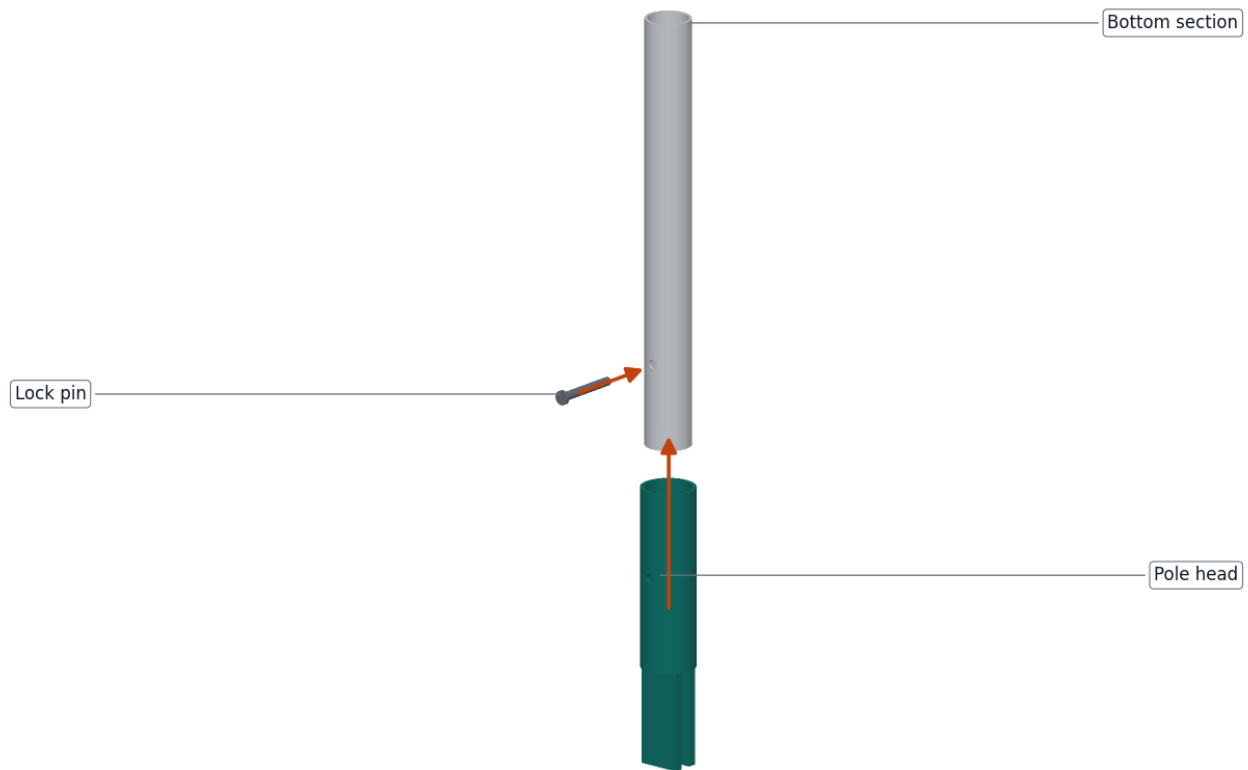
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Push a sleeve 100 onto the top of the bottom section until the rivet holes meet; fit one rivet each side. Do the same on the middle section. Hold point: pull each sleeve by hand; it must not move.

Step 5: fit the pole head

Step 5: fit the pole head to the bottom section

Head on until the pole meets the end plate; lock pin through, R-clip on



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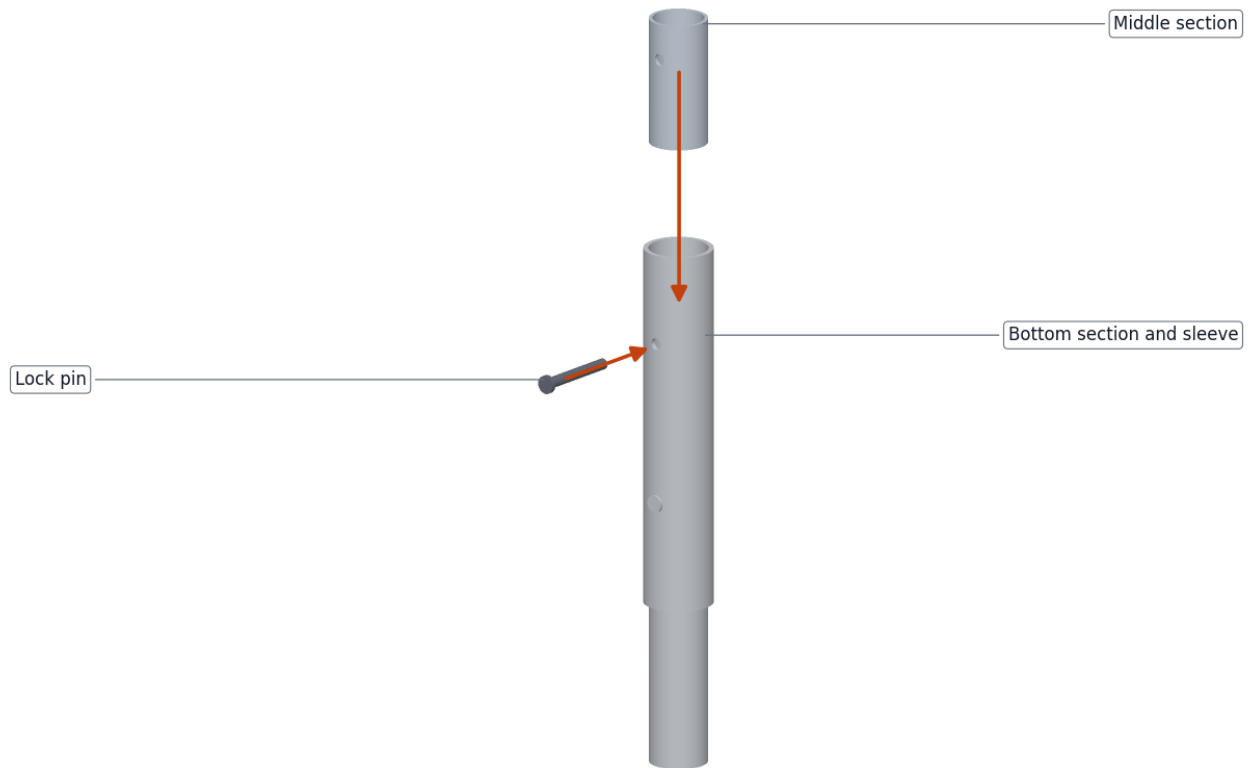
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Push the head onto the bottom of the bottom section until the pole rests on the end plate. Fit a lock pin through and its R-clip.

Step 6: join the sections

Step 6: join the sections

Middle section into the sleeve until it butts; lock pin through; the same for the top section, then the grip cap



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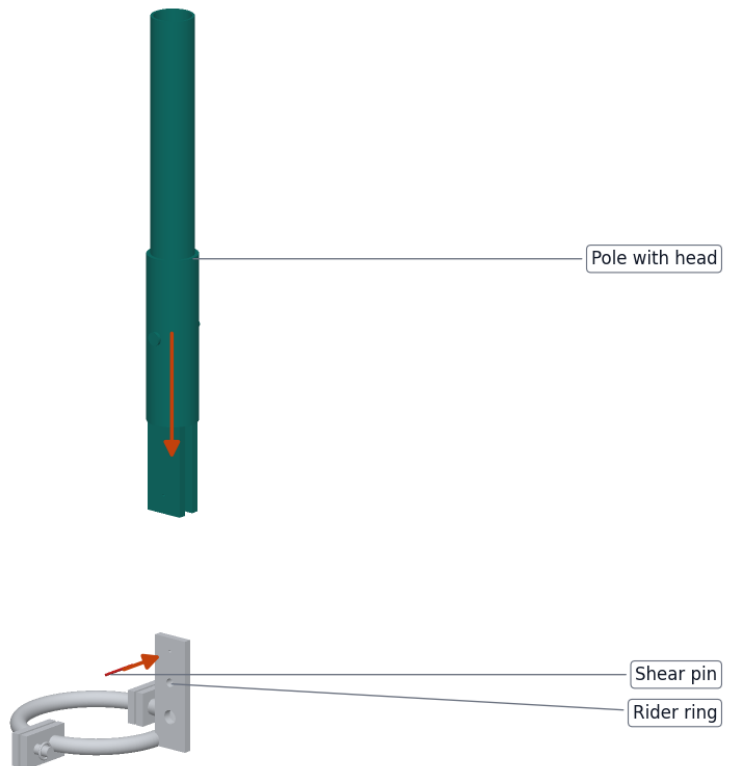
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Push the middle section into the bottom section's sleeve until it butts; fit a lock pin. Push the top section into the middle sleeve the same way and fit a lock pin. Push the grip cap on the top.

Step 7: fork on the tang, shear pin in

Step 7: put the fork on the tang and fit the shear pin

Line up the 2.1 mm holes, push the pin through, bend both ends over by hand



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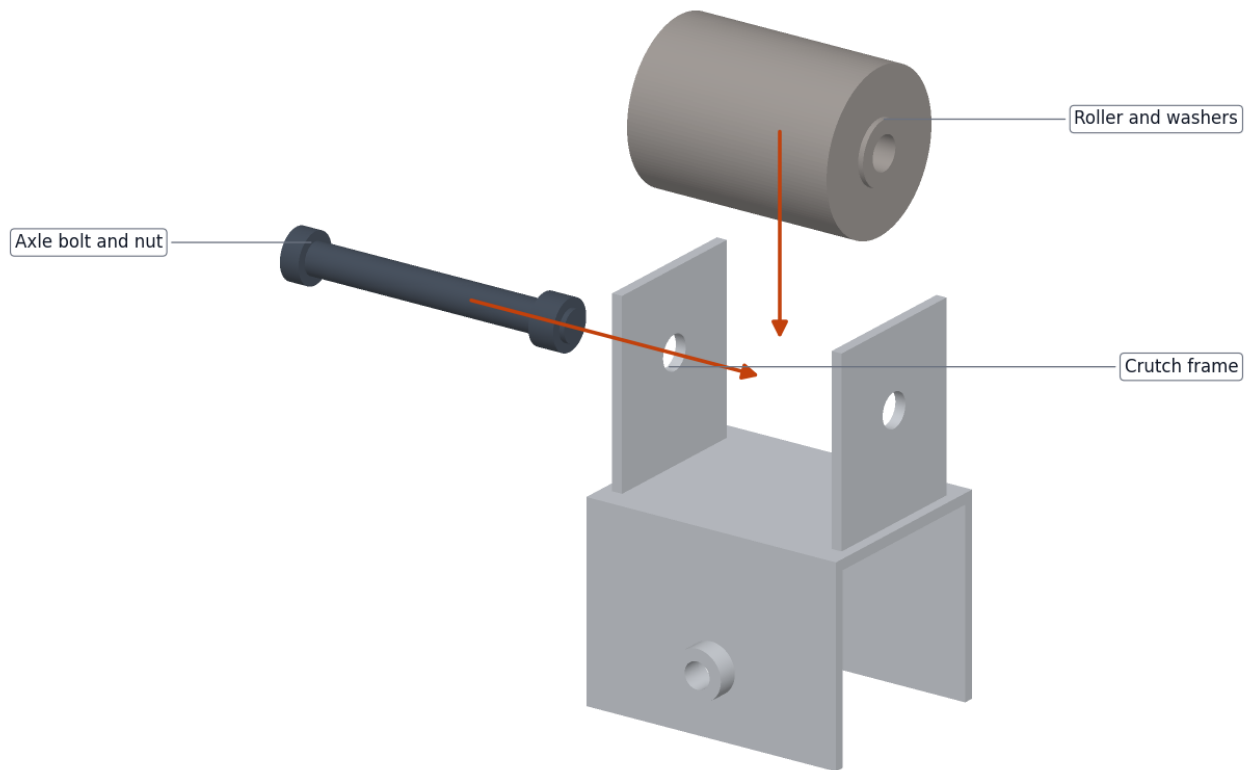
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Slide the fork over the ring's tang, line up the 2.1 holes, push a calibrated shear pin through and bend both ends over by hand. Hold point: never fit anything but a calibrated pin.

Step 8: fit the roller

Step 8: fit the roller between the cheeks

Washer each side, bolt through, nyloc nut snug; the roller must spin



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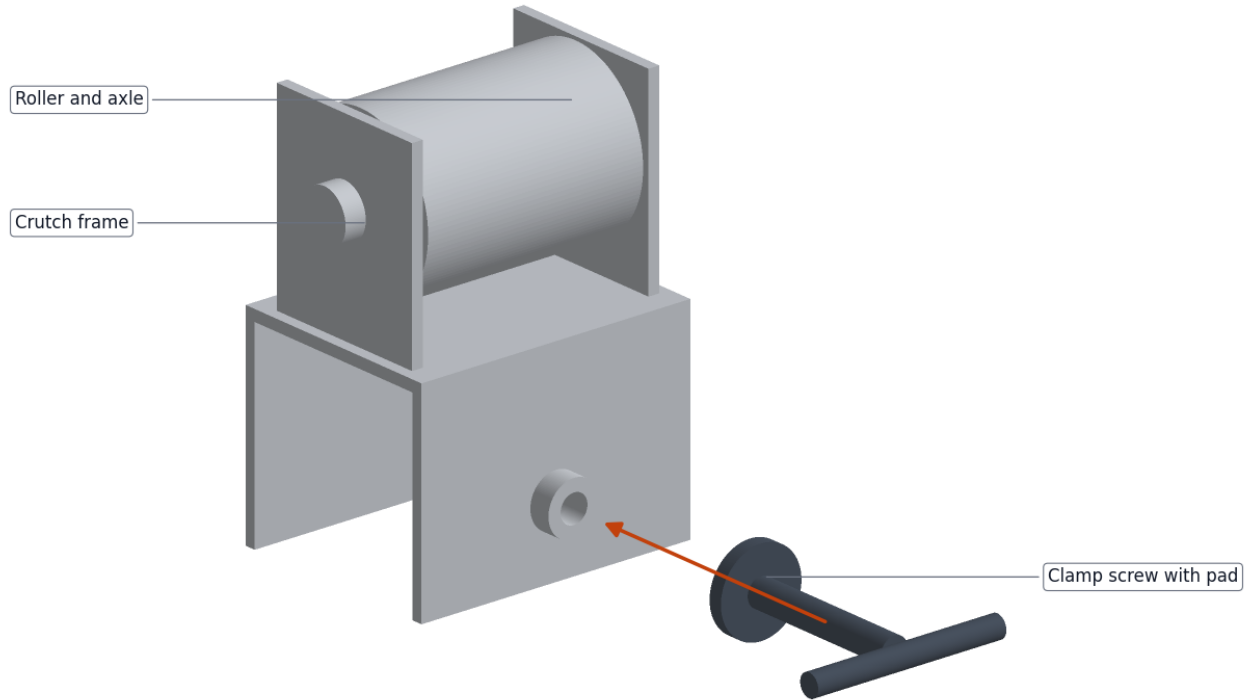
github.com/BoujeeEnjinia1701/stumprider

Put the roller between the cheeks with a washer each side, push the axle bolt through and do up the nyloc nut until it is snug; the roller must still spin.

Step 9: fit the clamp screw

Step 9: run the clamp screw into the welded nut

From outside the inboard leg, pad end first



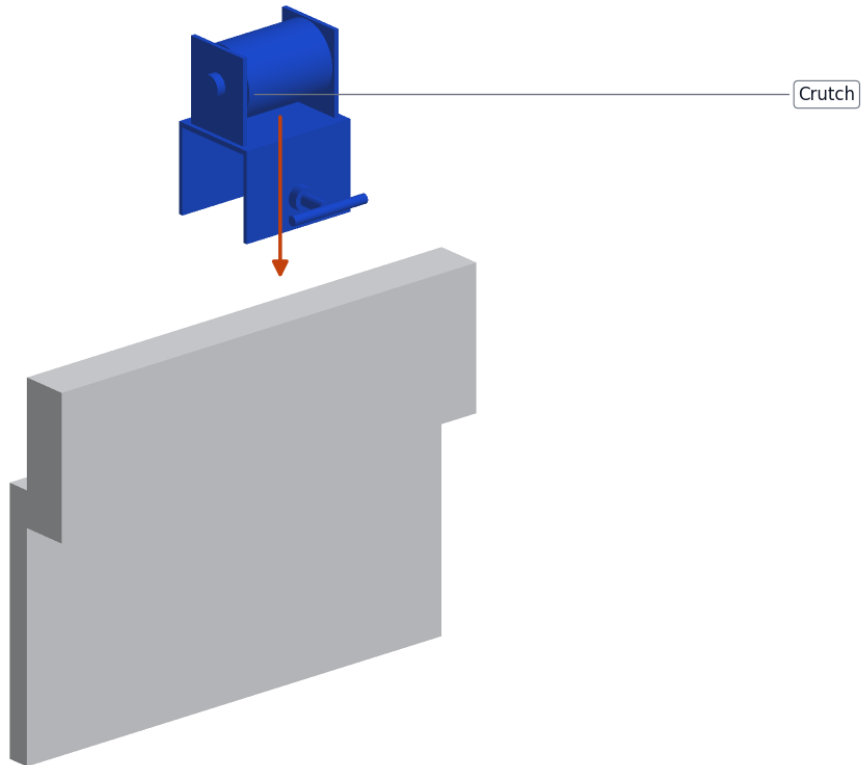
BUILD PLAN ILLUSTRATION, PLAN NOT YET BUILT

github.com/BoujeeEnjinia1701/stumprider

Run the clamp screw into the welded nut from outside the inboard leg, pad end first, until the pad is just inside the leg.

Step 10: clamp the crutch on the canoe**Step 10: clamp the crutch on the gunwale**

Near the bow, where the operator kneels; outboard leg on the outside, tighten the screw by hand



BUILD PLAN ILLUSTRATION, PLAN NOT YET BUILT

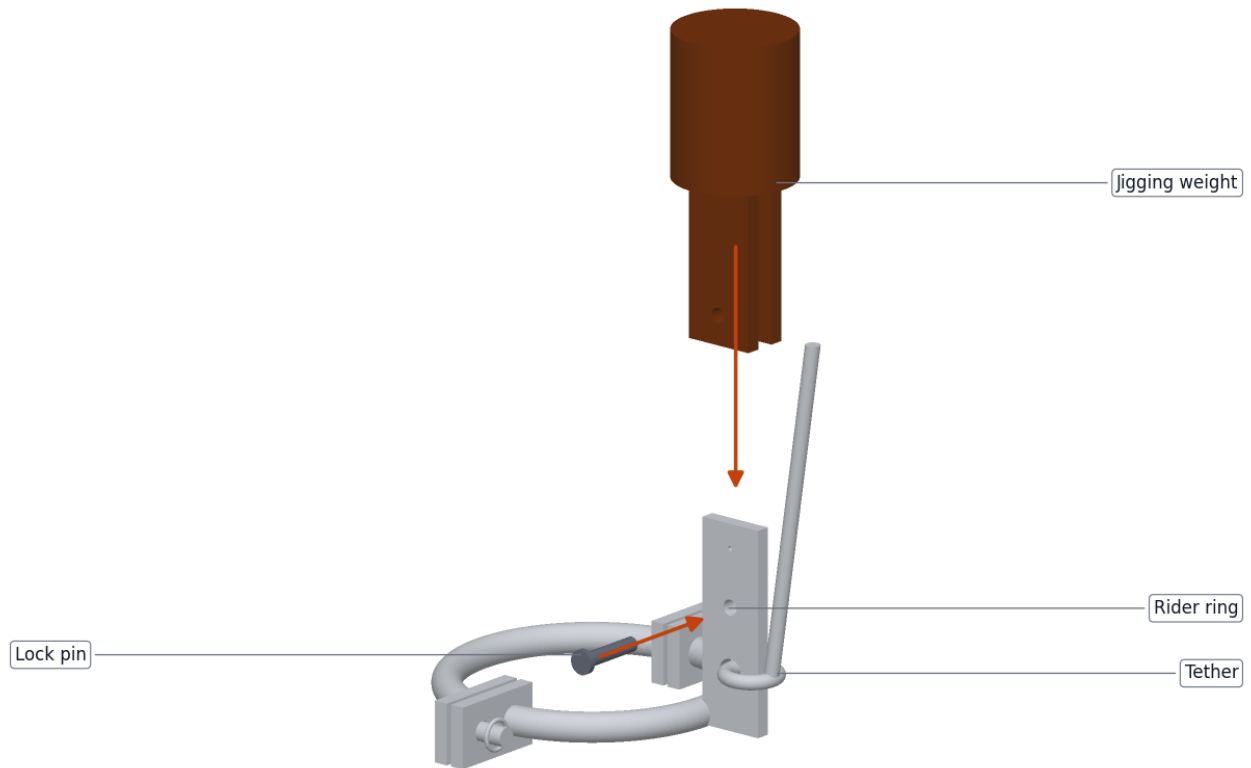
github.com/BoujeeEnjinia1701/stumpriider

Near the bow, where the operator will kneel, set the web on the gunwale with the outboard leg against the outside. Tighten the clamp screw by hand. Hold point: the crutch must not move when pulled hard by hand.

Step 11: jiggling set-up (deep snags only)

Step 11: for deep snags, pin the jiggling weight to the tang

Pole head off first; weight cheeks over the tang, lock pin through the middle hole



BUILD PLAN ILLUSTRATION, PLAN NOT YET BUILT

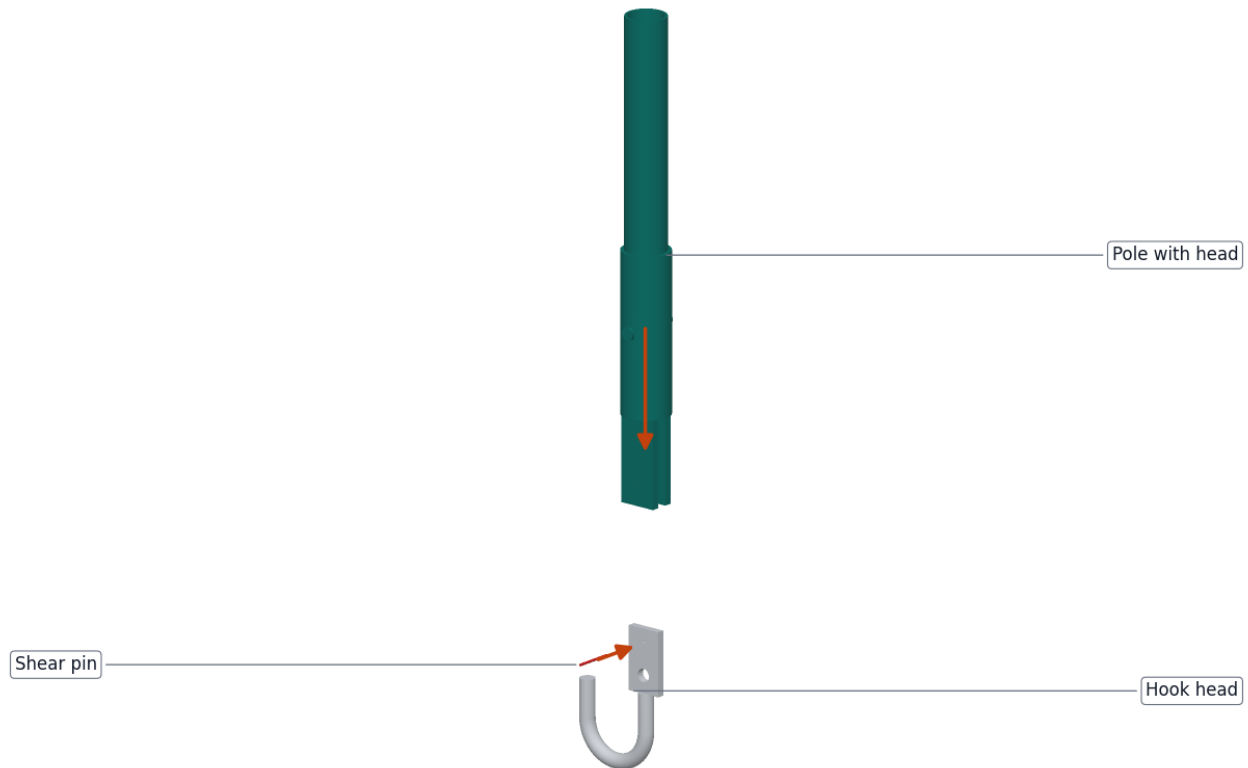
github.com/BoujeeEnjinia1701/stumprider

Take out the shear pin and lift the pole head off the tang. Put the jigging weight's cheeks over the tang and fit a lock pin through the middle hole. Tie the tether's end to a thwart before working. The jigging weight is kept at the landing and taken out only for a known deep set.

Step 12: hook head (wrapped nets only)

Step 12: for a wrapped net, put the fork on the hook head

Ring off the pole first; same shear pin, ends bent over; draw the bight back round the branch half a turn at a time



BUILD PLAN ILLUSTRATION, PLAN NOT YET BUILT

github.com/BoujeeEnjinia1701/stumpriider

Take out the shear pin and lift the pole head off the ring's tang. Put the fork over the hook head's flat, push a calibrated shear pin through and bend both ends over. Run the hook down beside the net line, catch the bight below the branch and draw it back round the branch half a turn at a time, kneeling, with the crew slackening the line. If the net does not come, cut it. Walking the ring back round the branch is still taught and tried first.

Local production variant (costed, built alongside at TRL 4)

The aluminium kit above is the design. A local production variant is costed line by line in `bom/bom-local-variant.csv` (SMR-DDR-003): three seasoned bamboo sections about 35 mm across, cut so a node closes each end and treated against rot, joined by pinned steel ferrules in place of the aluminium sleeves and rivets; and one crutch and jiggling weight shared by five canoes at a landing. It costs about USD 56 a kit and the carried kit is about 3.6 kg. It is built beside the aluminium prototype at TRL 4 so stiffness, rot and cost can be compared; it is not drawn at TRL 3.

■ 5. First checks

Table 2. First checks, listed here and recorded in a TRL 4 test report.

#	Check	Requirement	How	Pass when
1	Pin calibration	R3	Break ten pins from the reel in a test fork on CalRig, pulling slowly	All ten break between 256 and 347 N; otherwise change the wire diameter and repeat
2	Ring fit	R6	Close the ring on lines of 4, 8, 12 and 16 mm; slide it 1 m along each	Closes on every line and slides without catching
3	Pole and joints	R2, R7	Assemble, measure from 300 below the cap to the ring centre; pack the sections	At least 4.0 m; longest piece under 1.6 m; joints have no play you can feel
4	Release on a bench snag	R1, R3	Ring on a rope hooked over a fixed log, crew rope at 30 N, pull up the pole on a spring balance	Rope lifts clear below the pin rating, or the pin breaks inside its band and the pole comes away cleanly
5	Mass	R7	Weigh the whole kit and the working tool	Recorded against R7
6	Float	R7, R8	Hang the ring and cord on the winder in water	Floats
7	Canoe heel	R3	With the canoe moored in shallow, calm water, crew aboard in life jackets, pull the pole sideways from a fixed point ashore with a spring balance up to the pin rating; read the heel with an inclinometer	Heel at 347 N is 5 deg or less

■ 6. Safety stops

Work stops at each of these points and goes on only when everything listed is true.

- **S1, before welding:** working in the open, nothing galvanised in the weld zone, eye and hand protection on.
- **S2, before fitting any shear pin:** its reel has passed check 1; no other pin, nail, bolt or wire is in the kit.
- **S3, before taking the kit onto a canoe:** checks 2 to 6 passed; the crutch is clamped and pulled by hand; every person has a life jacket on.
- **S4, before the heel test (check 7) or any use on a snag:** the canoe is at least 7 m long with at least three crew, moored or in shallow, calm water; the operator kneels; the crew knows to slacken the line when the operator lifts and to cut the net if the canoe heels; nobody enters the water for any reason.
- **S5, after every pin break:** the operator is back in a kneeling position, the ring is recovered on its tether, and a calibrated pin is fitted before the next try.

■ 7. Tools, skills and workspace

- **Tools:** hacksaw or cut-off grinder, bench drill or hand drill with a vee block, drills from 2.1 to 13, a vice, a 100 mm round former, files and a flap disc, stick welder, pop rivet gun, sharp knife, tape and square, spring balance to 50 kg, bubble inclinometer.
- **Skills:** basic bending and welding of mild steel; drilling square through tube; tying a bowline.
- **Workspace:** an open-air workshop bench; a galvaniser for the steel parts (sent out once all welding is done); a calm, shallow mooring for check 7.

■ 8. Where the numbers come from

- Model: `cad/src/model.py` (sizes, constructability checks), STEP files in `cad/step/`.
- Drawings: `cad/drawings/SMR-DWG-001` (general arrangement) and `SMR-DWG-101` to `SMR-DWG-111` (making sketches).
- Calculations: `docs/04-calcs/01-sizing.md` (SMR-CAL-001), `docs/04-calcs/sizing.py` and `docs/04-calcs/results.csv`.
- Bill of materials: `bom/bom.csv` ; local production variant `bom/bom-local-variant.csv`.
- Pictures: `cad/src/build_plan_media.py`.